
Paper 3, Option 34.1:

Industrialisation and social change in Britain, 1759–1928: forging a new society

Overview

This option comprises two parts: the *Aspects in breadth* focus on long-term changes and contextualise the *Aspects in depth*, which focus in detail on key episodes.

Together, the breadth and depth topics explore ways in which Britain changed from the mid-eighteenth to the early twentieth century by looking at some of the industrial inventions and innovations that changed the lives of British men, women and children, alongside broader changes in the workplace and the profound changes in attitudes to children and childhood. Whilst mainly social and economic, this option also enables students to explore the impact of key political events and legislation.

Aspects in breadth: from wool combers to bus conductresses – a mobile society, 1759–1928	
Themes	Content
1 Changing patterns of adult work and working conditions	- Reasons for changes to working patterns and conditions, 1759–1928: the impact of legislation (key development: the 1833 Factory Act); the initiatives of employers, including the work of Titus Salt; the impact of technology (key developments: the move from domestic to factory employment from the mid-eighteenth century, the shift from water to steam power from the late eighteenth century, the spread of electrical power in the early twentieth century); the impact of the First World War on patterns of work. - The impact of workers' unions on working conditions, 1759–1928: the influence and limitations of workers' associations and unions to 1851; the role of new model trade unions from 1851; the influence of unskilled workers' unions from 1888 (key developments: the matchgirls' strike 1888, the Triple Alliance 1919).
2 The world of childhood	Changes to children's lives, 1759–1928: the impact of government action (key developments: Factory Act 1802, Mines Act 1842, Agricultural Gangs Act 1867, Children's Act 1908); the initiatives of employers and philanthropists, including Robert Owen and Dr Barnardo; improvements in education (key developments: the 1833 government grant and Education Acts in 1870 and 1918).

Aspects in depth: towards prosperity	
Key topics	Content
1 Josiah Wedgwood: china and canals, 1759–87	• The development of Wedgwood china: Josiah Wedgwood's experimental work; the roles of Sarah Wedgwood, Queen Charlotte, the Duke of Bridgewater; the influence of trade with the East in developing a taste for porcelain. • The importance to Wedgwood of the construction of the Trent and Mersey canal and availability of the canal system. • The significance of Josiah Wedgwood's involvement with the Society for the Abolition of the Slave Trade; the importance of the slave medallion.
2 Samuel Greg: cotton and cottages, 1784–1816	• The growth of Quarry Bank Mill: choice of site, impact of the French wars, 1793–1815, the roles of Samuel Greg, Peter Ewart, Matthew Fawkner and Hannah Greg. • Dealing with the labour problem; connections with the Poor Law system; accommodating and managing the workforce. • The significance of Quarry Bank Mill for the development of the cotton industry in Lancashire in the years to 1816.
3 Isambard Kingdom Brunel: railways and ships, 1833–59	• The construction of the Great Western Railway: the role of Brunel; the reasons for the 'battle of the gauges'; the Royal Commission 1845 and the Gauge Act 1846; reasons why Stephenson's narrower gauge became the standard. • Brunel's diverse design and engineering skills: problem solving during GWR line construction; innovative design of bridges, stations, ships and pre-fabricated hospitals for the Crimean War. • Impact of Brunel's work for passenger travel and for goods transport; the significance of Brunel's attempts to extend the GWR westwards to the USA.
4 John Kemp Starley: cycles, cycling clubs and emancipation, 1885–1901	• The significance of the design and production of the Rover Safety Bicycle; its economic importance, including impact on Coventry. • The impact of the safety bicycle on leisure pursuits; its political impact – the role of the Clarion Cycling clubs. • The significance of the safety bicycle for women – impacts on mobility, independence and fashion; opposition to the female bicycling craze; the significance of the concept of the 'New Woman' in the 1890s.
5 Herbert Austin: creating and adapting to market forces, 1905–28	• The Longbridge works, 1905–18: the role of Herbert Austin; pre-war car production; the impact of the First World War; the economic importance of Longbridge to the Midlands. • The Austin 7: reasons for its development and success; the impact on the Longbridge works.